

The Lawgivers Climb

History of law · teens–adult · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

“Before written law, the strongest man’s opinion WAS the law. What changed — and who changed it?”

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Climb through the lineage — when Hammurabi, Moses, Solon, Justinian, Magna Carta, or the Constitution appears, place it on a quick hand-drawn timeline on paper as you go.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. Why does writing a law DOWN change everything — even a harsh law?
2. Which idea was bigger: that kings make law, or that law binds kings?
3. Which ancient legal idea do you still live under today, this very afternoon?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Five questions; timeline-keepers add what they meet.

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Civilization is the agreement that rules outrank rulers.”

Homework: Find one rule in your own home or workplace that exists in writing — and ask who it protects.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.